



CHAPTER 4 OFFICE ENVIRONMENT



Learning Outcomes

- To identify the key elements of the office environment and understand their importance to the organization.
- To explore green office environment and their importance in promoting sustainability. • To understand the impact of a healthy office environment.
- To understand the importance of energy conservation and office security.
- To demonstrate the ability to evaluate and suggest improvements in office environment practices through observation and interview techniques.

Content

The background of the slide is a photograph. On the left, there is a large green curved shape, possibly a desk or a wall panel. On the right, a portion of a laptop keyboard is visible. In the bottom right corner, two hands are clasped together, with a silver metal mesh watch visible on the left wrist.

4.1 Management of Office

4.2 Impact of Office Environment on Employees

4.3 The Healthy Office Environment

4.4 Conservation of Energy in Offices

4.5 Office Security



CHAPTER 4.1

MANAGEMENT OF OFFICE

Office Environment



- The physical environment in which employees work often affects their productivity and job satisfaction.
- The office environment can affect the financial well-being of the organization, especially when employee's dissatisfaction with their working environment has a negative impact on their productivity.
- The environment of the office is multifaceted (complex).

A banner image for the 'Green Office Movement'. It features a dark green background on the left with the title in white. On the right, there's a photograph of a laptop keyboard and a person's hands clasped in front of it. A stylized green graphic of a person with a large head and small body is also visible.

Green Office Movement

- Trend for an increasing number of organizations to become environmentally conscious by recycling of paper, retrofitting of lighting, heating, and air-conditioning systems.
- Overall, the green office movement is concerned with indoor air quality, energy conservation, and reduction of waste and natural resources.



Techniques Used to Facilitate the Green-Office Movement

- Installing light sensors that automatically adjust the artificial light supplied to a given area, based on the amount of natural light available.
- Installing movement-based sensors in workstation that dim the light when their occupants are not present.
- Installing small-zone heating and air-conditioning system that can be activated by employees who work after hours.
- Recycling drinking water, after it has been filtered.
- Installing roofing materials that reflect sunlight rather than absorb it.
- Recycle as much discarded paper as possible.
- Shutting off all electronic machines at the end of the work day.



Elements of the Office Environment

1. Lighting
2. Colors
3. Noise Control
4. Conditioning the Air
5. Music



CHAPTER 4.2

IMPACT OF THE OFFICE ENVIRONMENT ON EMPLOYEES

Impact of the Office Environment on Employees



- Each of the elements in the office environment can affect office employees physically and psychologically.
- **Ergonomic** - the study of the relationship of employees to their physical environment, is helpful in designing a suitable environment.
- **Ergonomic** helps ensure the task, the tools and equipment used in task performance, and the environment in which the employee works, match his or her needs.

Set Up an Ergonomic Workspace

These tips come courtesy of Steve Meagher, from ergonomics consulting firm Site Solutions.

Maintain good posture

Keep your back straight—remember, no slouching!—with your head balanced above your neck, and arms resting at your sides comfortably.

Adjust seat

Position your hips a bit higher than your knees, with your feet on the floor/footrest and your lower back supported.

Position monitor

Raise or lower it so you can clearly see the whole screen without tilting your neck up or down.

Place keyboard and mouse

Keep them close to each other on the same level, with the home row of keys easy to reach with your elbows positioned at 90°. As you type, your wrists should be straight.

Rest regularly

Every 20 minutes or so, take short, 15- to 30-second breaks. Take a few longer breaks during the day.

—Jason Cross





CHAPTER 4.3

THE HEALTHY OFFICE ENVIRONMENT



The Healthy Office Environment

- One of the office environment concerns that receive an increased amount of attention is how to provide a healthy workplace for employees.
- **Sick-building syndrome**
 - Result from unfavorable environment conditions phenomenon of the last two decades.
 - This syndrome manifest itself among employees in the following ways: headaches, dizziness, abnormal tiredness, breathing difficulties, sore throats, coughing, skin rashes etc.

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1. REPETITIVE MOTION INJURIES
 2. ELECTROMAGNETIC RADIATION
 3. COMPUTER VISION SYNDROME
 4. INDOOR POLLUTION
 5. NOISE POLLUTION
 6. POOR LIGHTING SYSTEMS
 7. NON-ERGONOMIC FURNITURE
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Situations Creating Unhealthy Office Environment

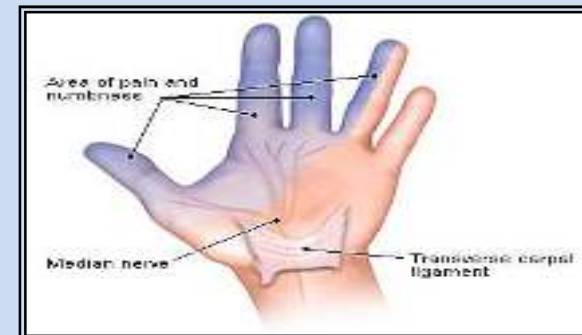
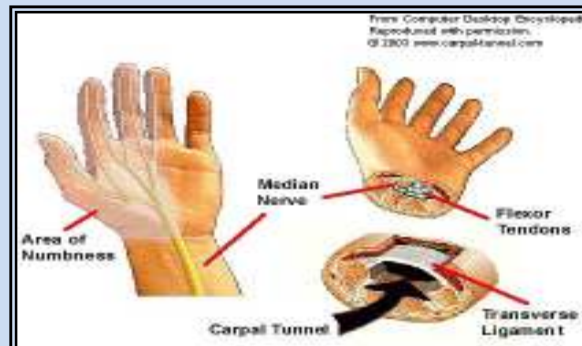
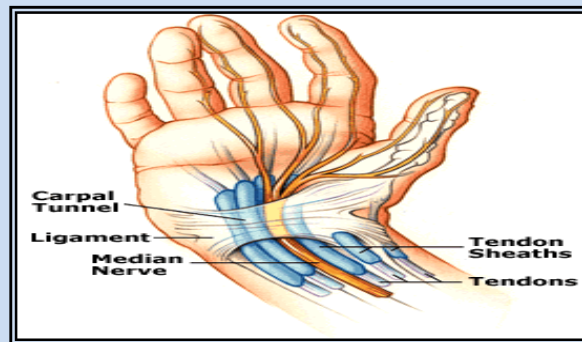
Situations Creating Unhealthy Office Environment



Situations Creating Unhealthy Office Environment

Repetitive motion injuries

Carpal tunnel syndrome





CHAPTER 4.4

CONSERVATION OF ENERGY IN OFFICES



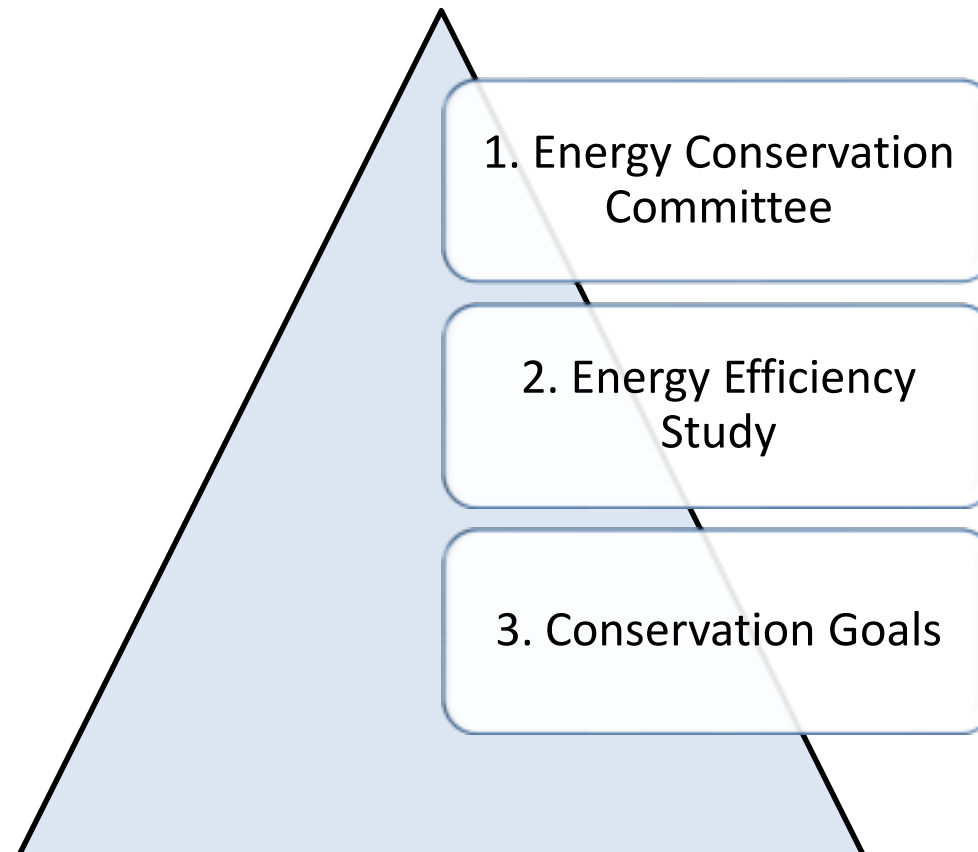
Conservation of energy in office

Conservation of Energy

- One of the realities of life is the growing need to conserve energy.
- The development of a proper attitude toward energy conservation has to start at the top of the organizational management.
- Implement The Energy Conservation Program.

Conservation of energy in office

Components of an Energy Conservation Program





Conservation of energy

Techniques for Conserving Energy : Lighting Systems

Techniques for Conserving Energy : Heating/Cooling System

Techniques for Conserving Energy : Other Conservation Measures



CHAPTER 4.5

OFFICE SECURITY

OFFICE SECURITY



Protection of the organization's physical property.

For example:
Equipment, machines
& furniture.

Protection of the organization's vital information.

For example: Data & records

OFFICE SECURITY

Limiting access to vital areas—use restrict access:

- Photo IDs, Pushbutton locks, or Card-lock system.
- Fingerprint and eye-oriented system.
- Proximity card – allow card holder access to a secure area.
- Automatic light control system – body heat sensors.
- Sound alarm system.
- Security guard.
- Use passwords to access data.



REFERENCES

- **Main Reference**
- Quible, Z. K. (2014). **Administrative Office Management**. 8th edition. Pearson Education Limited.
- **Additional Reference**
- Kallaus, N. F. & Keeling, L. B. (1996). **Administrative Office Management**. SouthWestern Publishing Co.



END OF CHAPTER 4